

Directory

Aaron Copland

1900–1990, AMERICAN

One of the outstanding figures in 20th-century American music, Copland was a pianist, conductor, writer, teacher, and concert organizer, as well as the composer of a large, varied, and memorable body of work. His training included a period of study in Paris with French composer and conductor Nadia Boulanger (1921–1924). Although he was sometimes influenced by various avant-garde elements, he is best known for works of wide popular appeal in an accessible, distinctively US idiom, sometimes quoting folk songs, with lively rhythms and a bracing sense of the open air. Particularly well known in this vein are his ballets *Billy the Kid*, *Rodeo*, and *Appalachian Spring*. His other work includes three symphonies, two concertos (for piano and clarinet), chamber and instrumental music, songs, choral pieces, and compositions for the stage, film, and television.
